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“After North America, we have opened our second largest facility in the world in India”

If you thought India was lagging behind other countries in adopting open source technology, think again! When Red Hat made its expansion plans, it considered India the place where it could find the ‘appropriate’ talent. Besides, Evans Data’s Global Developer Population and Demographic Survey conducted in 2011 reveals that India is among the rising technology powerhouses and by 2015, this country will surpass the United States with more than 3.5 million professional software developers.

Red Hat recently announced the expansion and launch of two ‘Engineering Centres of Excellence’ in Bengaluru and Pune. The Pune centre, spread over 4645 sq m (50,000 sq ft), is Red Hat’s second largest engineering facility in the world, the largest being in North America.

Located at two of India’s most prominent IT hubs, the newly inaugurated facilities reflect Red Hat’s increased investments in the country. With its expansion in India, Red Hat hopes to incubate, sustain and support local talent and maintain the high quality of contributions to the open source community, both locally and internationally.

Diksha P Gupta of **LINUX For You** spoke to **Anuj Kumar**, general manager, Red Hat India, and **Paul Cormier**, executive vice president and president, Products and Technologies, Red Hat Inc, about the two new centres, their upcoming products and Microsoft’s new open source subsidiary. Read on...

Q Red Hat has recently announced the expansion and launch of two ‘Engineering Centres of Excellence’ in Bengaluru and Pune. Any reasons for choosing India for its expanding operations?

Anuj: After North America, we have opened our second largest facility in the world in India. Now, there are essentially two facilities in India. One with services like support and an R&D centre, which is at Pune and an R&D centre in Bengaluru, the latter being the new one. These are part of the global R&D centres, so they are not specific to the Indian geography. 2012 is the ‘Year of the Developer’ for Red Hat. With our new facilities, we hope to continue showing our commitment to developers throughout the APAC region.

Q What kind of manpower do you plan to employ in these R&D centres?

Anuj: We cannot specify the number of people we will hire in each of these facilities, but the most we can say is that it is the second largest expansion for Red Hat, in the world. Essentially there are four engineering centres across the world. The first is in Boston, there’s another at Brno in the Czech Republic, and we have a couple in India.

Q Any reasons for choosing India for the second largest centre?

Anuj: To be honest, it is just part of our natural expansion. The Pune facility was set up a long time ago and has provided support and engineering operations since 2002-2003. So this is not a new facility. In fact, most of the front line support services for home support, documentation and support tools are all developed and maintained from the Pune facility. So this is just part of the natural process by which Red Hat has grown over time. That’s the case with Pune. For Bengaluru, it is a different case. We have acquired a storage company about five-six months ago. And most of engineering in that company was done in Bengaluru. So it was natural for us to consolidate and have our storage business unit, essentially the engineering, be based out of Bengaluru.